

FAST TRACK · SOC · JUNE 2026

One hire. One promotion.

Promote Matteo to Junior SRE. Backfill his seat. Both together — or neither works.

SOC headcount

Internal growth

Shift structure

GPTW

SRE maturity



THE FOUNDATION

Chapter one: delivered

5 engineers. Built from scratch. 24/7 coverage from day one.

95%

24/7 shift coverage delivered by SOC — without SRE cover

90%

Alarms resolved without SRE or Dev escalation

100s hrs

Engineering time returned to Dev over the past year

24 / 7

Partner platform coverage — all shifts, all week

HOW — 1 SENIOR SOC + 4 SOC ENGINEERS

- **Matteo (Senior SOC)** anchored fixed day shifts Mon–Fri — the knowledge backbone, escalation point, and team lead
- **4 SOC engineers** in rotation covered Day / Late / Night with confidence
- Partners supported at any hour. Dev stayed focused on building.



We already know what 4 SOC engineers looks like. We're living it.

One engineer left months ago. What follows isn't a projection — it's what we've been running on ever since.

65%

24/7 shift coverage by SOC with 4 engineers — SRE absorbing the remaining 35%

1,300

Alarms per month handled across just 4 engineers — and we're already reducing noise

SRE ON-CALL IS FILLING THE GAP

- 35% of shifts now require SRE to cover — **during their own on-call period**
- This is not additional capacity — it's borrowed time
- Adding workload and fatigue to both teams simultaneously

COGNITIVE LOAD & ESCALATIONS

- 1,300 alarms across 4 engineers = **325 per person per month**
- High volume leaves no room for deeper product knowledge
- More alarms handled = more escalations to SRE and Dev

LEAVE IS NO LONGER VIABLE

- 4-person rotation has **zero buffer** for absence
- Engineers are effectively unable to take meaningful leave
- Sustained pressure compounds attrition risk further

ATTRITION RISK — AND 3 SOC BREAKS US

- Sustained pressure with no growth path is the **fastest route to losing someone**
- Lose one more engineer and we're at 3 — overnight coverage fails, SRE absorbs shifts indefinitely
- No breathing room = no path to specialisation — **growth is the retention lever**

THE SOLUTION

→ 5 is the operational minimum for 24/7 — the promotion unlocks what comes next

4 engineers cannot sustain round-the-clock coverage indefinitely. This isn't a growth ask — it's the floor.

THE VICIOUS CYCLE — IF NOTHING CHANGES

4 SOC → Overloaded ratios → More SRE escalations → No room to grow → Problem compounds ↻

Matteo

Senior SOC Engineer

→ Junior SRE

- Solves SRE-level incidents already — the move is already earned
- Bridge engineer: keeps SOC ↔ SRE knowledge flowing
- Visible proof that internal growth is real, not just a talking point

WHAT A FULL 5-PERSON TEAM MAKES POSSIBLE

- **24/7 only holds at 5** — four engineers covering all shifts leaves zero margin. One absence and the rotation fails; SRE picks up shifts that aren't theirs to carry.
- **Day shifts jump from 4 to ~9 per month** — in a 4-person rotation, each engineer gets just 4 day shifts a month. At 5, nearly 45% of the schedule falls during business hours.
- **Proximity to tech is where growth happens** — day shifts put SOC alongside SRE and engineering. That's where knowledge transfers: alarm tuning, incident triage, escalation context — not in isolation at 3am.
- **Any SOC engineer can develop toward more specialised roles** — with breathing room in the rotation, growth stops being theoretical. The path is open, not blocked.
- **AI investment becomes viable** — bandwidth to build what reduces long-term load, rather than just surviving the current one.



THE ASK

Approve the promotion + 1 backfill hire

One decision. Everything else follows.

WHAT WE NEED

Matteo → Junior SRE + 1 SOC backfill hire

- Promotion alone = 4 in rotation — breaks 24/7, not sustainable.
- Matteo stays Senior SOC — and he won't stay long. Growing into SRE has been his goal since day one. He's earned it, and without the promotion, we lose him.
- Both together secures the team we have and opens what comes next.
- Even as automation takes on more work, the right technical capability in-house remains critical.

4 → 9

Office days per month per engineer with 5-person rotation

5 SOC

Operational floor restored — 24/7 holds, leave is viable, one departure no longer puts the whole rotation at risk.

Chapter 2

SOC vision unlocked — AI-enabled, product-fluent, close to engineering